

The Tired Smile

Player-facing description

The Tired Smile: Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before.

Public role

Clue / evidence

Handout text

Player-safe note: Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before.

GM truth

Use this element to reveal the cost of managed protection through concrete play.

GM handling

Use when players need a tangible handle on the scene's pressure.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn The Tired Smile when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-the-tired-smile-engage-the-tired-smile entity-the-tired-smile Engage The Tired Smile Engage The Tired Smile Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of The Tired Smile hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that...
- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal

without closing off player agency.

- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Player-safe note: Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before.

Profile

- Schema Version: clue-profile-v1
- Id: the-tired-smile
- Clue Id: the-tired-smile
- Clue Name: The Tired Smile
- Name: The Tired Smile
- Pronunciation: the TY-erd SMYL
- Clue Kind: behavioral
- Auto Surface: True
- Atlas Lore Note: [Atlas lore - confirm or override]
- Player Safe: The Tired Smile Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before. Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before. Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before.
- Block0: the-tired-smile The Tired Smile the TY-erd SMYL behavioral
- Block1: the joy is real and so is the exhaustion; they carry both at once. HIDDEN Hush's Hidden Struggle hush-hidden-struggle Keeps Hush warm while making the cost of protection concrete. <pages/entities/the-tired-smile.html> <pages/clues/hush-hidden-struggle.html>
- Block2: Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before. the joy is real and so is the exhaustion; they carry both at once.
- Block3: "her smile flickered, just for a beat." "under the cheer, she's exhausted." You have enough GM-only proof that the villagers' joy is real and their exhaustion is real too. You have enough GM-only proof that the villagers' joy is real and their exhaustion is real too.
- Block4: The Patched Everything The Ward Subscription the-patched-everything the-ward-subscription
- Block5: S03-01 S04-03 Hush Fidget Yera Mossglass Instinct 13; an empathetic PC. clues/Hush_Hidden_Struggle.md
- Block6: HIDDEN Use this clue to support Hush's Hidden Struggle: the joy is real and so is the exhaustion; they carry both at once. whisper True
- Block8: Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no repeated icon. Depict: a warm villager's smile caught mid-flicker, deep tiredness behind the eyes. clue wiki card and Player Display evidence visual Send the image and SHOW text only. Keep TELL, points_to, and blunt ladder rungs GM-only until earned. /Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-

atlas/src/clue_images/the-tired-smile/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-tired-smile/profile_base.png Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark...

- Block9: Official Daggerheart action roll using Duality Dice, Hope, Fear, and Difficulty; P2P Roll Slider is the table-facing result ladder. Agility move, climb, dodge, reach a better angle, or read evidence while moving Strength lift, hold, force, carry, break, or test weight and pressure Finesse handle, hide, tinker, compare, pick apart, or notice precise detail Instinct perceive, smell, listen, track, read danger, or sense body language Presence charm, soothe, press, lead, deceive, perform, or read a social response Knowledge recall, analyze, investigate, reason from lore, or understand systems Instinct D14 Knowledge D14 Presence D14 If the clue is plainly visible, give the SHOW text freely first: Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before. Use the listed Difficulty for the chosen trait. Lower rolls get...
- Mechanics: duality-dice hope fear difficulty roll-slider clue-discovery
- Visual Assets: profile_base Clue evidence image /Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-tired-smile/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-tired-smile/profile_base.png ready The Tired Smile clue image. Mid-laugh, a villager's smile slips for half a second ? bone-deep tiredness underneath ? and then snaps back, brighter than before.

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